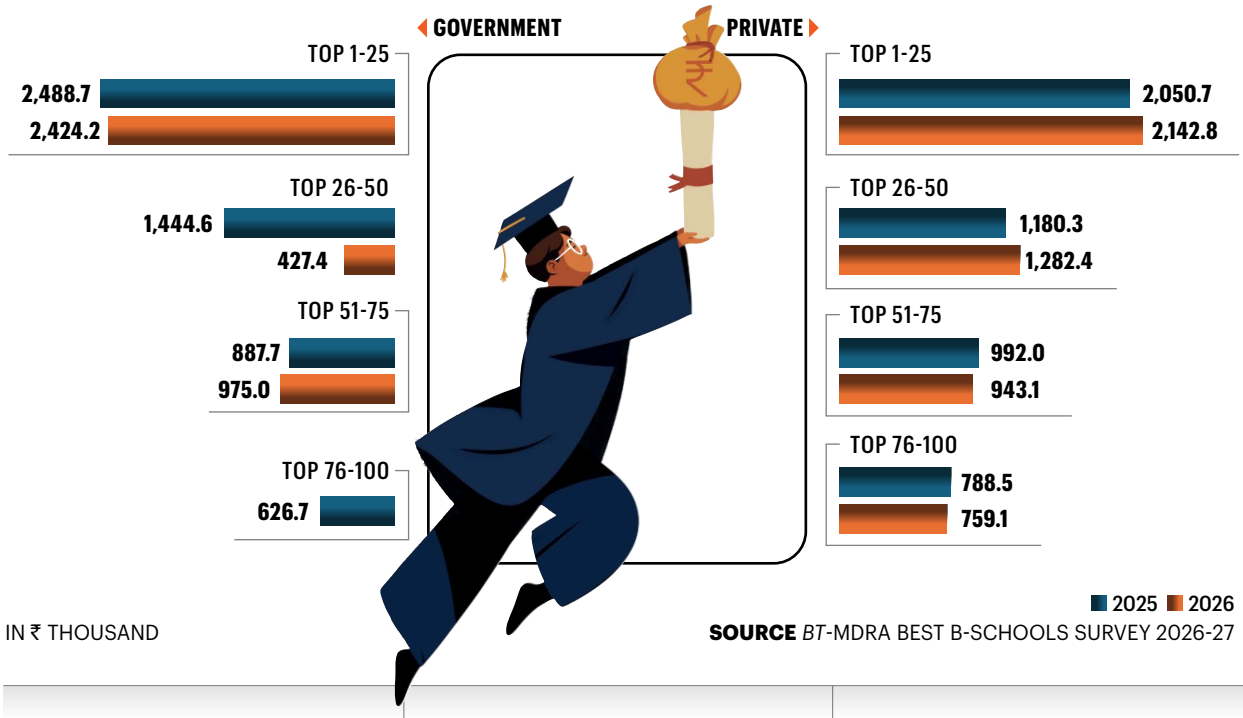
SALARY STRUCTURE

• Domestic salaries at government B-schools show a mixed but generally improving picture outside the Top 50 • Private B-schools in the Top 50 category recorded salary growth, whereas the lower-ranked segments saw a declining trend



IN ₹ THOUSAND

SOURCE *BT*-MDRA BEST B-SCHOOLS SURVEY 2026-27

institute, the highest stipend was ₹3 lakh compared to an average ₹94,220 for the top 30%.

PROOF IS THE NEW CURRENCY

At K J Somaiya, while recruiters are looking for students who know how to use AI effectively, the bigger shift is towards demonstrable skills. Placement Chairperson Anjali Chopra says simply describing oneself as "AI-enabled" on a CV is no longer enough.

Recruiters want to know whether a student has built a prototype, created a workflow that improved efficiency, used AI during an internship, measured its impact, or completed a project using the technology.

IIM Kozhikode's Chatterjee says prior work experience, performance during internships and live projects, and functional depth in areas such as finance, consulting and analytics offer evidence that a candidate can hit the ground running after joining a company.

At MDI Gurgaon, students are increasingly assessed through group activities, case evaluations and leadership exercises, while soft skills carry particular weight in client-facing roles. Prior work experience and domain exposure can provide an edge, but freshers still bring qualities such as innovation and out-of-the-box thinking that employers value.

B-schools are responding to the new environment by broadening what counts as employability. MDI Gurgaon says its curriculum has been overhauled to reflect the changing workplace, including programmes in business analytics and banking and finance, alongside live projects, guest sessions and student-driven activities.

And K J Somaiya has an initiative that evaluates students beyond CGPA, including case competitions, extracurricular activities, sports and other forms of engagement.

AI is accelerating this shift. Companies are evaluating which repetitive tasks can be automated, making them more selective about the entry-level roles they create.

According to Chatterjee, organisations are shaping roles around digital transformation, analytics and AI adoption, and looking for managers who can combine business judgement with a working understanding of data and technology.

Han Digital identifies demand across risk management, finance and audit, technology strategy, go-to-market strategy, sales and rev-